

Competitive landscape synthesis

The core problem is validated

The "save and forget" problem is real and cross-platform. Users articulate it themselves: Google Maps lists become noise past ~30-50 places, with no search, no filter, and no way to act on them. The group-planning pain is equally documented - group chat deadlock, one person carrying the coordination burden, options scattered across tools.

What Moves actually is (sharpened)

Moves is not a list-sharing or voting tool. It is a **plan-decision product**:

1. Import your Google Maps saved places
2. AI generates 2-5 step itinerary options based on personal criteria (budget, vibe, user history, group preferences, opening hours)
3. Share those complete plans - not a list - to one or multiple groups in one click, with average cost, menus, and links
4. Group votes on Plan A vs Plan B vs Plan C
5. Memory of what you chose, with who, and when

This is fundamentally different from Google Maps collaborative lists, where groups vote on individual venues in a static list. Moves collapses a messy saved list into a few high-quality complete plans before the group ever sees it.

The real competitive wedge

The specific bundle no competitor delivers:

- **Import your own saved places** (not nearby discovery, not Stippl-native saves)
- **AI generates complete itinerary options** from those saves using personal criteria
- **One shareable link** with plan options, average cost, menus, website links
- **Group votes on plans** (not places) across multiple groups simultaneously
- **Memory layer** of past outings with who and when

Competitor map

Not real threats

- **Wanderlog, Triply** - travel-focused; Wanderlog's AI ignores your saves; Triply is a thin indie MVP (~7 App Store ratings)
- **AI generators (Layla, Roam Around, GuideGeek)** - generate from scratch, no saved-places input, travel-only
- **Swipe-to-decide apps (Spork, Chicken Tender, Hangrily, ~8 others)** - vote on individual venues from nearby discovery, not curated saves; all have negligible adoption; the category has failed repeatedly

Partial overlaps - individual features only

- **Stippl** - real funded competitor (250K users) with strong social/collaboration, but no Google Maps import; saves are Stippl-native only; AI generates from prompts, not your saves; buggy and "overwhelming" UX
- **Beli / Rex / Swarm / Mapstr** - memory and "been/want-to-try" tracking, but no planning or group decision layer

- **Rally, Tine** - voting on plans but no saved-places import, no cost/menu bundling; negligible adoption
- **Google Maps collaborative lists** - emoji voting on lists, free and native, but votes on individual places not complete itineraries; no AI-generated plans; no cost/menu/link bundling

The sharpest threat: Mindtrip

- Imports Google Maps saved pins via share flow
- Works locally, not just for travel
- Group chat and real-time collaboration
- **But:** import may be pin-by-pin (not bulk confirmed); no structured plan voting; AI quality unverified by independent users; positioned as global travel tool, not local social planning

What is NOT a differentiator

- Memory alone - Beli, Rex, Swarm all do this
- Group voting alone - Google Maps, Rally, and ~8 swipe apps all do this; the category has failed at retention
- "AI that plans your own saves" alone - Triply does this (poorly); table stakes

Corrections to original thesis

- "Social/group planning is a green field" - wrong; Stippl has full collaboration, Google Maps has list voting
- "Memory of past outings is novel" - wrong; Beli, Rex, Swarm cover this
- Pricing at \$5/month (\$60/year) - above market; category ceiling is ~\$25-40/year or free; the "pay to save over 50 places" gate is especially risky

The Google Maps objection - answered

When users hear the pitch, they'll say "Google Maps already lets me share lists and vote." The answer: Google Maps votes on individual places in a list. Moves votes on complete 2-5 step itineraries, AI-generated from your saves using criteria Google Maps doesn't know, sent to multiple groups at once. That's a different product.

What to watch

- **Mindtrip** needs hands-on testing - it's the closest competitor and its Google Maps import and group features need verification
- **Google Maps** is the real incumbent to beat, not the indie apps - if its collaborative lists get better, it compresses Moves' space
- The swipe-to-decide graveyard is a warning: voting on venues alone has never retained users; Moves' edge is that you vote on pre-filtered plans from your own curated saves